

Re-analysis Summary Report for Peer-evaluation

Paper ID: Adida_CompPolitStu_2016_G0Kb

Re-analyst's ID: zzy2r

Your task

As a peer-evaluator, for this paper you are asked to judge whether the analyst's applied analytical choices for Task 1 and Task 2 are acceptable. By acceptable, we mean that the analysis pipeline is within the variations that could be considered appropriate by the scientific community in addressing the given analytical task. In addition, for Task 1, we ask you to judge whether the reported conclusion adequately follows from the results of the analysis; whether the co-analyst's self-categorization of the result is adequate. Although, you are not required, it would be appreciated, if you could execute the accompanying analysis code to check any mismatch between the results of the analysis and the reported results.

For both tasks, you should provide your evaluation via this survey: <https://forms.gle/EAREaC6JjN2PWFfR6>

The re-analyst's task

The re-analyst was instructed to assess the following claim of the original authors:

... priming the first lady's ethnicity increases support for President Yayi among her coethnics. (p. 635.)

The corresponding article

Here you can find the original article: https://osf.io/hcxdq/files/osfstorage/5e21e2a6675e0e009c6b4d01/?view_only=c874fcf097644e82a320679d4641163a

and the original data: https://osf.io/avj8y/?view_only=978a4c4cd219427c9f529a1128478dc7

They are provided only as context of the re-analysis.

In Task 1, the analyst was asked to conduct the analysis without any restrictions. Here, the analyst reported the following steps and results of the analysis:

A total of 1104 participants completed the questionnaire distributed in Benin in 2012. For the main analysis, I filtered the data in the following way. First, I excluded 637 participants who were assigned a different experimental condition than the three of interest: (a) "control," in which participants were not given a reference to President Yayi's wife ($n = 140$); (b) "wife," in which the text participants read mentioned that President Yayi had a wife ($n = 132$); and (c) "Fon wife," in which the text mentioned that President Yayi had a Fon wife ($n = 141$). I then excluded an additional 54 participants who identified as Yoruba, President Yayi's ethnic group (this subsample was also excluded from the analysis in the main article). The resulting sample included a total of 413 participants (mean age = 32.5, SD = 10.2, 47.7% female, 152 Fon [President's wife coethnic group], 261 non-coethnic).

This analysis was conducted to verify the following claim in the abstract of the original paper: "Our results confirm that priming the First Lady's ethnicity increases support for President Yayi among her coethnics." To test this claim, I fitted a logistic regression model with the willingness to vote for President Yayi in elections (0 = no; 1 = yes) as the dependent variable, the experimental condition (control, wife, Fon wife) as the first predictor, and participants' coethnicity (coethnic [FON], non-coethnic) as the second predictor.

Considering that the claim refers to the interaction between the experimental condition (referred to as prime in the original paper) and participants' coethnicity (or lack thereof), I added the interaction terms between the two predictors.

The results of this model show no significant interaction between the experimental condition - disclosure of information about the President's wife (without reference to her ethnicity) - and the coethnicity of the participants, $b = -0.20$, $SE = 0.64$, $z = -0.31$, $p = .758$. However, there was a significant interaction between disclosure of information about the President's Fon wife and participant coethnicity, $b = -1.58$, $SE = 0.55$, $z = -2.88$, $p = .004$. Because of the presence of a significant interaction, I do not report the main effects. Visual inspection of the nature of the interaction shows trends in the same direction as in the original paper. Post-hoc analysis (b coefficients are given on a log odds ratio scale) with a Tukey p-value correction for multiple comparisons indeed revealed that the probability of voting for President Yayi was higher among Fon coethnics when participants were informed that his wife was Fon than when they were informed only that he had a wife, $b = 1.42$, $SE = 0.53$, $z = 2.69$, $p = .020$. Similarly, comparing the control condition, in which participants were not informed at all about the President's wife, to the experimental condition, in which they were informed that he had a Fon wife, increased the likelihood of voting among Fon coethnics, $b = 1.04$, $SE = 0.43$, $z = 2.39$, $p = .045$. There was no effect of the experimental condition among non-coethnics, with all $ps > .196$.

Overall, the following claim "Our results confirm that priming the first lady's ethnicity increases support for President Yayi among her coethnics" was supported.

The analyst's conclusion: Showing participants a brief reference to President Yayi's Fon wife increases the likelihood that they will vote for the President, compared to showing them information that the President has a wife or showing them no information about his marital status.

The analyst's categorization of the result:

The results show evidence for the relationship/effect as described in the claim provided in your task

In Task 2, the analysts received the following instruction to conduct the analysis:

You should restrict your analysis to Benin-related survey experiment data.

Here, the analyst reported the following steps and results of the analysis:

[The same preprocessing steps as in Task 1 below]

A total of 1104 participants completed the questionnaire distributed in Benin in 2012. For the main analysis, I filtered the data in the following way. First, I excluded 637 participants who were assigned a different experimental condition than the three of interest: (a) "control," in which participants were not given a reference to President Yayi's wife ($n = 140$); (b) "wife," in which the text participants read mentioned that President Yayi had a wife ($n = 132$); and (c) "Fon wife," in which the text mentioned that President Yayi had a Fon wife ($n = 141$). I then excluded an additional 54 participants who identified as Yoruba, President Yayi's ethnic group (this subsample was also excluded from the analysis in the main article). The resulting sample included a total of 413 participants (mean age = 32.5, $SD = 10.2$, 47.7% female, 152 Fon [President's wife coethnic group], 261 non-coethnic).

This analysis was conducted to verify the following claim in the abstract of the original paper: "Our results confirm that priming the First Lady's ethnicity increases support for President Yayi among her coethnics." To test this claim, I fitted a logistic regression model with the willingness to vote for President Yayi in elections (0 = no; 1 = yes) as the dependent variable, the experimental condition (control, wife, Fon wife) as the first predictor, and participants' coethnicity (coethnic [FON], non-coethnic) as the second predictor. Considering that the claim refers to the interaction between the experimental condition (referred to as prime in the original paper) and participants' coethnicity (or lack thereof), I added the interaction terms between the two predictors.

[Task 2 result below, i.e., the single main result obtained from formally testing the claim]

There was a significant interaction between disclosure of information about the President's Fon wife and

participant coethnicity, $b = -1.58$, $SE = 0.55$, $z = -2.88$, $p = .004$.

Analysis language/software/code (optional to check):

Task 1: R

Task 2: R

Analysis codes: <https://osf.io/67u9c/>